

SM PHARMACEUTICALS SDN BHD

XETEC (CETIRIZINE) 5 MG ORAL SOLUTION AND 10 MG TABLET

DESCRIPTION:

Oral Solution: Clear colourless to slightly yellow, fruity flavoured syrup

Tablet: A White to off white, oblong shaped, film coated tablet with score on one side.

COMPOSITION:

Each 5ml contains: Cetirizine Dihydrochloride 5mg

Each tablet contains Cetirizine Dihydrochloride 10mg

ACTIONS AND MODE OR MECHANISMS OF ACTION:

In experimental animals, Cetirizine has been shown to be an anti- H_1 agent devoid of any significant anticholinergic or antiserotonin effects. At pharmacologically active doses, it induces neither sedation nor behavioural changes. This may be explained by the fact that Cetirizine does not cross the blood-brain barrier. It was shown in human pharmacology studies that Cetirizine will inhibit certain effects produced by exogenous histamine. This activity appears rapidly. Cetirizine also inhibits the effects produced by endogenous histamine released *in vivo* by an agent, eg 48/80. Finally, it inhibits the cutaneous reaction induced by VIP (Vasoactive Intestinal Polypeptide) and substance P, neuropeptides which are believed to take part in the allergic reaction.

Cetirizine inhibits the histamine-induced "early" phase of the allergic reaction. It also significantly reduces the migration of inflammatory cells such as eosinophils and the release of mediators associated with the "late" allergic response.

Cetirizine markedly reduces bronchial hyper-reactivity to histamine in the asthmatic patient. It also reduces the allergic reaction induced by specific allergens. These effects are obtained without any central effects being demonstrated either by psychometric test or by a quantified EEG.

PHARMACOLOGY (SUMMARY OF PHARMACODYNAMICS AND PHARMACOKINETICS):

Peak blood level of the order of 0.3 micrograms / ml are reached between 30 and 60 minutes after administration of a 10 mg dose of Xetec. Its plasma half-life is approximately 10 hours in adults, 6 hours in children aged 6 to 12 years and 5 hours in children aged 2 to 6 years. These data are consistent with the urinary excretion half-life of the drug. The cumulative urinary excretion represents about two third of the dose given in both adults and children. Consequently, the apparent plasma clearance in children is higher than in adults. Absorption is very consistent from one subject to the next. The plasma levels are proportional to the administered dose. Cetirizine is strongly bound to plasma protein.

INDICATIONS:

Adult and children of 3 years or above: symptomatic treatment of seasonal rhinitis perennial allergic rhinitis and urticaria of allergic origin

CONTRAINDICATIONS:

Patients with a history of hypersensitivity to any of Xetec constituents. Xetec is contraindicated during lactation.

SIDE EFFECTS / ADVERSE REACTIONS:

There have been occasional reports of mild and transient subjective side-effects such as headache, dizziness, drowsiness, agitation, dry mouth and gastro-intestinal discomfort. In objective tests of psychomotor function, the incidence of sedation with cetirizine was similar to that of placebo.

Occasionally symptoms of hypersensitivity have been reported.

PRECAUTIONS / WARNINGS:

Activities requiring mental alertness: In clinical trials the occurrence of somnolence has been reported in some patients taking Cetirizine. Due caution should therefore be exercised when driving a car or operating potentially dangerous machinery.

At therapeutic doses, Xetec does not potentiate the effects of alcohol (at blood level of 0.8 g/l). Care should, however, be taken.

The safety and effectiveness of cetirizine in pediatric patients under the age of 2 years have not been established.

PREGNANCY AND LACTATION:

Teratology studies in animals have not demonstrated any special malformations. As a precaution, Xetec should not be administered to pregnant women during the first three months of pregnancy. Xetec is contraindicated in lactating women since the active ingredient, cetirizine is excreted in breast milk.

DRUG INTERACTIONS:

To date, there are no known interactions with other drugs. Nevertheless, Xetec should be used with caution if sedatives are also being taken.

RECOMMENDED DOSAGE, DOSAGE SCHEDULE AND ROUTE OF ADMINISTRATION:

In children 3 to 6 years old: 5 mg once daily or 2.5 mg twice daily.

In children 6 years old or above: 10 mg once daily or 5 mg twice daily.

In adults: 10 mg once daily.

In patients with renal insufficiency, dosage should be reduced to half the daily dose.

It is advisable to take the drug with a little liquid during the evening meal since the symptoms for which the product is given usually appear during the night. In patients

affected by side effects, the dose may be taken as 5 mg in the morning and 5 mg in the evening.

SYMPTOMS AND TREATMENT FOR OVERDOSE AND ANTIDOTE(S):

Drowsiness can be symptoms of overdosage, occurring from administration of 50mg of Xetec as a single dose.

To date, there is no specific antidote. In the case of massive overdosage, gastric lavage should be performed as soon as possible. Usual supportive measures should be provided and routine observations carried out regularly.

PACKING / PACK SIZES:

Oral Solution: Amber coloured bottles of 60 ml and 100 ml.

Tablet: Blister of 10's, 2 x 10's/Box, 10 x 10's/Box

STORAGE CONDITIONS, USER INSTRUCTIONS AND PHARMACEUTICAL PRECAUTIONS:

Store below 30°C. May cause drowsiness. Avoid alcoholic beverages.

SHELF LIFE:

For Tablet:

2 Years

For Oral Solution:

3 Years

Manufacturer and Product Registration Holder:

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10.10.2023